@heycutiees_ Growth Report

Harshita Agrawal · Travel India · Prepared 12 Oct 2026 from a 60-second screen recording of the profile

5,052	4,349	48K	46/100
followers	median views, 35 reels	best reel (11.0x median)	profile score

The short answer. Reach is not the problem: the typical reel already gets about as many views as there are followers, and two reels went past 40,000. What holds growth back is that (1) the profile does not turn those viewers into followers, and (2) the content is split across four kinds of reel when one of them clearly beats the others.

The five moves, in order

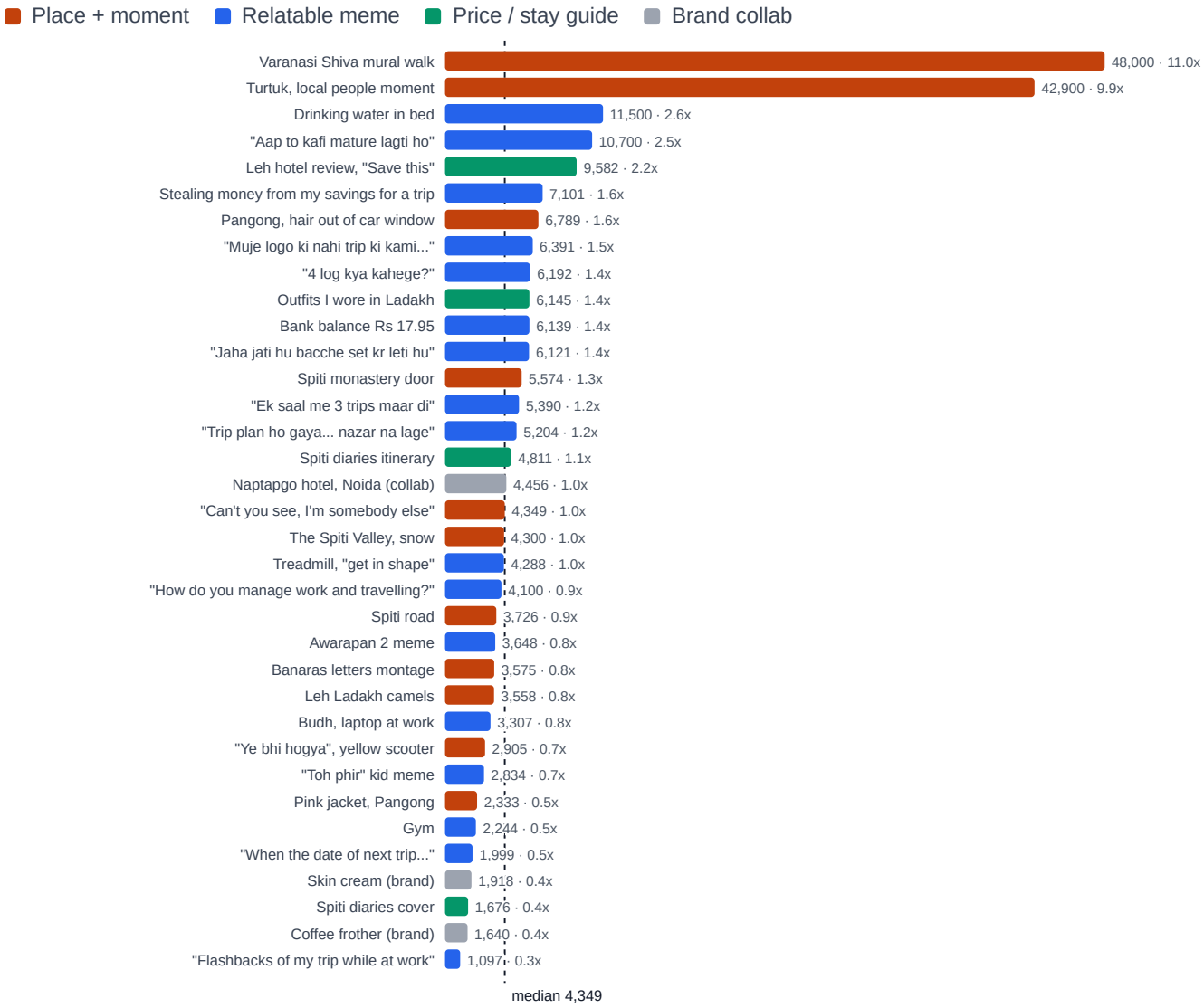
1. **Pick one angle and say it everywhere:** weekend and budget trips across India on a 9-to-5 salary. Your own audience already asks about exactly this.
2. **Fix the profile** (name field, bio, pinned three, highlights, link, photo). This is where the 48K-view reel's viewers decided whether to follow.
3. **Make more "place + a moment" reels**, the shape behind both big hits, and fewer relatable memes.
4. **Add a keyword ask to every guide** ("Comment BANARAS") so posts collect comments, saves and DMs.
5. **Grow through other people:** collab posts with peer travel creators, 20 minutes of commenting a day, daily stories.



What this report could and could not see. The recording shows the profile, highlights, grid and the view count on each reel. It does not show reach, shares, saves, watch time or follows per reel. Every finding below is based on views only, across 35 reels. That is enough for a rough pattern, not proof. The most useful number to check next in Instagram Insights is how many follows the 48K and 42.9K reels brought in.

1. Content audit: what is working

Raw views mostly reflect how many people already follow an account, so each reel is measured against the account's own median (4,349 views). Anything above 3x is a real hit; below 1x is a quiet day.



1. Content audit (continued)

Type of reel	Reels	Median views	Average vs median	Best vs median
Place + moment	11	4,300	2.7x	11.0x
Relatable meme	17	5,204	1.2x	2.6x
Price / stay guide	4	5,478	1.3x	2.2x
Brand collab	3	1,918	0.6x	1.0x

The "place + moment" average is pulled up by the two hits. Without them, plain scenery reels sit at about 1x. The lesson is the moment, not the scenery.

What the data says

1. **Both big hits share one shape:** one specific place plus one human or spiritual moment, with very little text (Varanasi Shiva mural, 11.0x; Turtuk people, 9.9x). Scenery without that moment does about 1x (Pangong, Spiti snow, camels).
2. **Relatable memes are steady but capped.** 17 of them, averaging 1.2x, none above 2.6x. They keep the account ticking over and they do not grow it.
3. **Guides with real prices or stays beat memes.** The Leh hotel "Save this" reel did 2.2x and Ladakh outfits 1.4x. These are also the posts people save and send.
4. **Brand collabs are the weakest posts** (0.4x to 1.0x). Fine for income, but they should not take the best posting slots.

> **Stop:** posting relatable meme reels most days (cap them at one a week).
> **Do more:** "place + a moment" reels and budget breakdowns with real numbers.

Views without follows is a profile problem

A reel that gets views and no follows has not failed; the profile has. A reel with no views is a hook problem. With a median close to the follower count and two reels near 10x, this account's bigger gap is the profile, which is the next section.

2. Profile score

46/100

Most first-pass profiles land in the 30s and 40s. Recent activity and stories could not be seen and are scored halfway.

Item	Score	Why
Name field	9/12	"Travel India" is searchable but generic
Bio line one	5/12	"Work → Save → Travel → Repeat" hints at the angle but does not say who it is for
Bio body	3/8	Two "Managed by" handles send visitors away
Pinned three	6/10	All three are destinations; none introduces you
Link	**0/8**	No link
Highlights	3/8	About 15 highlights named after places, nothing for a newcomer
Grid	5/8	Mostly readable covers, mixed message
Photo	2/6	Logo text with a tiny figure, no face at thumbnail size
Handle	2/6	"heycutiees_" says nothing about travel
Category / contact	3/6	Creator category set, no visible email button
Recent activity	5/10	Not visible in the recording
Stories	3/6	Not visible in the recording

Fixes, biggest first

1. Name field (30 characters, pick one, this is what Instagram search reads):

```
Harshita | Budget Travel India
Harshita | Weekend Trips India
Harshita | India on a Budget
```

2. Bio (121 characters):

```
Weekend trips across India on a 9 to 5 salary.
Itineraries with real prices, Ladakh to Banaras.
Collabs: DM or email 📩
```

3. Pinned three: the Varanasi reel (best proof), the Banaras "under 3k" itinerary (clearest offer), and a new 20-second "who I am" reel.

4. Highlights: replace the place names with *Start here · Itineraries · Prices · Stays · Collabs*, plus three or four region highlights (Ladakh, Spiti, Maharashtra, Varanasi/MP).

5. Link: one page holding the itineraries. **6. Photo:** your face filling the circle. **7. Handle:** changing it is optional and costs some recognition.

> Expected score after these fixes: around 80. The rest comes from a posting and story habit, not from more rewriting.

3. The next reel, ready to shoot

Hook options (scored by the hook checker)

Score	Hook
80.8 STRONG	"You do not need 2 lakh rupees to see Ladakh."
79.4 STRONG	"Banaras for under 3,000 rupees. Nobody believes me."
75.1 STRONG	"My first 200 reels did nothing. Here is what changed on the Varanasi one."

Banaras script · about 31 seconds · human-voice score 86.6 PASS

Fill in the {{ }} blanks with your real numbers; none were made up.

```
Banaras for under 3,000 rupees. Nobody believes me.
So here's every rupee.
Train from {{your city}}, sleeper, {{train fare}} rupees.
Hostel near Assi Ghat, {{hostel price}} a night.
Breakfast was kachori sabzi for {{price}}.
Sunrise boat ride, {{boat price}}.
Ask for a shared boat.
Evening aarti at Dashashwamedh is free, just get there an hour early so you actually see
it.
Total, {{total}} rupees. Two days. One weekend, no leave.
Comment BANARAS and I'll send you the full list.
Under 3,000. Still don't believe me?
```

- Put each price on screen as you say it, six words or fewer per card.
- The aarti line runs about 6 seconds, so cut to a second shot halfway through.
- The last line repeats the hook, so the replay loops cleanly.

Caption · linter READY · human-voice score 90.5 PASS

```
Comment BANARAS and I'll DM you the full list, with every hostel, ghat and price.

A 2 day Banaras weekend trip. No leave taken. Train, hostel near Assi Ghat, kachori for
breakfast, the sunrise boat, and it all came to under 3,000 rupees, which I'm still a
little smug about.

Got a 9 to 5? Budget travel in India doesn't need a long holiday. It needs a Friday night
train.

#varanasi #banaras #budgettravelindia
```

Cut "smug" if it does not sound like you. One ask only, three hashtags, search phrases ("budget travel", "Banaras", "weekend trip") written into the text.

4. The week

Day	Time	Format	Post
Mon	-	Engage	20 minutes of commenting only
Tue	7:30pm	Reel	Banaras under 3,000 (script above)
Wed	-	Stories	Question box: "Next weekend trip: where?"
Thu	7:30pm	Carousel	Leh stays by budget, building on the 2.2x hotel reel
Fri	7:30pm	Reel	"You do not need 2 lakh rupees to see Ladakh"
Sun	6:30pm	Reel	One place + one human moment, 15 to 20 seconds, Varanasi/Turtuk shape

At most one relatable meme reel a week. Posting time matters far less than the first two seconds of the reel.

Story sequence for Wednesday

#	On screen	Sticker
1	You at your desk with your bag packed for the weekend	-
2	Clip from the Banaras reel: "This one was one weekend."	-
3	Talking to camera: what you look for in a weekend trip	-
4	"Where should my next weekend trip be?"	Question box
5	"Best answer becomes Sunday's reel."	-

Reply to every answer. The answers are next week's hooks, in your audience's own words.

5. How to grow the follower count

1. **One angle:** weekend trips on a salary. People follow when they can tell what the next post will be.
2. **Make more Varanasi/Turtuk-style reels.** That shape is what reaches people who do not follow you yet.
3. **Keyword ask on every guide.** Each comment boosts the post and opens a DM. Instagram's own keyword auto-reply is allowed; mass-DMing people who did not comment is not and gets accounts restricted.
4. **Collab posts with peer creators.** A collab post appears on both accounts and reaches both audiences, the strongest free growth lever on Instagram.
5. **20 minutes a day, before posting:** comment on 10 accounts (5 bigger travel creators, 3 peers your size, 2 hostels or homestays). Add a price, a tip or a real experience, never just "nice".
6. **Reply to every comment in the first hour.** If one question keeps coming up, answer it with a reel reply.
7. **Stories daily:** 3 to 5 frames, with a poll or question box on the 4th frame.

Collab pitch to adapt (send by hand)

```
Hi {{name}}, your {{specific reel}} is the reason I finally went to {{place}}. Idea: a
joint reel, "{{place}} on a 9 to 5 budget", where you do the stay and I do the full price
breakdown, posted as a collab so it lands on both our grids. I'll handle the edit. Want to
do it on your next trip?
```

If they do not reply: one follow-up after 4 days with something new, one closing message after 10 days, then stop.

Not done yet

- **Competitor check.** Send 6 to 12 travel accounts near your size (or screenshots of your Saved collection) and they can be ranked the same way, to find which formats are working in the niche right now.
- **Your voice.** Transcripts of 3 of your own reels will make future scripts sound more like you.
- **Insights.** Reach, shares, saves and follows per reel would turn the patterns above from likely into confirmed.

Scores come from the insta skill's local checkers (hook scorer, beat timer, caption linter, human-voice score). They are heuristics, not Instagram's own numbers. Nothing was posted or changed on Instagram.